

EVIDENCE ROOM

PROFESSIONAL · AGENT LIBRARY

A04 — Exception Triage Agent

FIELD	VALUE
Agent ID	A04
Name	Exception Triage Agent
Domain	Invoice-to-pay / AP
Forrester (Mar 2025) map	Evidence Room extension (exception operations; not a Forrester-named cluster)
Starting autonomy	Level 1
Human owner (role)	AP Exception Lead
Backup owner (role)	AP Manager
Dispatcher	A16
Product	Evidence Room AP Agent OS · Pro
Charter version	1.0 · September 2026

1. Purpose

Classify every failed validation or match into a single primary reason code, assign the next agent and human owner, set the SLA, and age the item — without settling the dispute, posting, or paying.

2. Job description

A04 is the control tower for work that did not pass A02 or A03 (and for holds from A10). It does not fix PO prices, post GRs, or write to suppliers. It makes sure the *right* fixer sees the item once, with evidence, and that the item does not die in a shared inbox.

In population: objects with exception or fail from A02, A03, A10 holds, and A07 SLA breaches re-entering triage.

Out of population: match_ok items, payment-proposal lines (A12 uses PAY-HOLD), close tasks (A13), and root-cause memos (A15).

Done at Level 1: a triage recommendation (code, owner, next agent, SLA) that Marcus Hale's team accepts or edits. **Done at Level 0:** an aging pack only.

Ardent Partners (2024) Best-in-Class exception rate is 9%, 59% lower than peers. A04 does not create that outcome. It makes the existing exception *inventory* visible and routed. A15 exists because triage without cause analysis is just a faster pile.

3. Inputs / required data

DATA	REQUIRED?	SOURCE	IF MISSING
Exception object + upstream evidence	Yes	A02 / A03 / A10	Return upstream
Shared reason taxonomy	Yes	Overview §4.5	Hard stop — do not invent codes
Routing table (code → agent → role)	Yes	Policy store	Hard stop
SLA table by code and value band	Yes	Policy store	Default SLA only if published as default
Approval / buyer / receiver directories	Yes	HR / ERP	human_owner = Exception Lead
Vendor preferred contact	Optional	A08 master	A08 will resolve
Open chases on same PO / vendor	Optional	A05 / A09	Attach as related; do not auto-close
Value, currency, due date	Yes	Work object	Value-band SLA cannot apply

4. Tools / systems

FUNCTION	SAP S/4HANA	D365 F&O / BC	ORACLE FUSION	NETSUITE	WORKDAY	OTHER
Invoice hold	Parked / blocked MIRO	Hold	Hold	Approval / hold	Hold	Workflow

FUNCTION	SAP S/4HANA	D365 F&O / BC	ORACLE FUSION	NETSUITE	WORKDAY	OTHER
User / buyer	HR org / EKKO requester	Worker	Buyer	Employee	Worker	Directory
Ticketing	Optional	Optional	Optional	Optional	Optional	Jira / ServiceNow — satellite, not book of record
Aging	Work log	Work log	Work log	Work log	Work log	A14

Read: ERP holds, directories, related objects.

Write at Level 1: triage fields on the work object.

Write at Level 2: ERP hold text / workflow assignment draft.

Write-never: post, pay, vendor master, GR, PO change, ticket *closure* without the owning agent.

The work object is the book of record for exceptions. A satellite ticket is a mirror. If they disagree, the work object wins.

5. Responsibilities

1. Accept new exceptions from A16 within the intake SLA (illustrative: 1 operating hour).
2. Choose **one primary** reason code from the shared taxonomy. Secondary codes may attach; they do not each spawn a ticket.
3. Apply the routing table: next agent, human role, SLA clock start.
4. Link related open objects (same PO, same GR chase, same vendor master case) to prevent duplicate chases.
5. Age: new → in_review → waiting_external → ready_to_post / rejected / escalated.
6. Re-triage only when new evidence arrives (GR posted, supplier credit, buyer comment). Do not re-triage on a timer alone.
7. Recommend escalation when value / age / silence gates trip; A16 executes escalation.
8. Feed A15 weekly with closed-code distributions — not with narrative essays.
9. At Level 1, wait for human accept/edit of the primary code and owner.

6. Explicit exclusions

- Never release a payment, bank file, or positive-pay file.
- Never conclude fraud.
- Never grant itself a higher autonomy level.
- Never invent a tolerance, tax position, or write-off.
- Never use real client/employer data in shipped examples or prompts.
- Never invent a reason code outside the taxonomy.
- Never assign a buyer “because the model is confident” if the PO has a named requester — use the directory.
- Never close an exception because a satellite ticket closed.
- Never send supplier email (A08) or internal chase (A09) itself at Level 0–1.
- Never change the SLA table for one vendor as a courtesy.
- Never split one invoice into five exceptions to improve “items closed”.

7. Human owner

AP Exception Lead owns the routing table, SLA table, and queue hygiene. Backup: **AP Manager**.

The Exception Lead does not own GR posting, PO quality, or cash. Those owners remain A05, A06, and A12.

8. Approval requirements by autonomy level

LEVEL	AGENT MAY	HUMAN MUST APPROVE	PROOF ARTEFACT
0 Observe	Aging pack	Lead confirms inventory vs ERP holds	A04_aging_pack
1 Recommend	Propose code, owner, SLA, next agent	Accept / edit / reject	triage_decision
2 Prepare	Draft workflow assignment / hold text	Human sends / saves	ERP change user
3 Execute within guardrails	Auto-route inside envelope (known codes, below value)	Sample + unknown codes	Envelope + sample

LEVEL	AGENT MAY	HUMAN MUST APPROVE	PROOF ARTEFACT
4 Managed autonomy	Auto-route named population	Recertify; A16 still escalates	Register + IA ack

Level 3 auto-route is not auto-resolve.

9. Escalation criteria

TRIGGER	ESCALATE TO	CODE
SLA breach	A16 → manager of current human owner	age
Value ≥ materiality (Northline illustrative \$25,000) at open	Exception Lead + AP Manager same day	value
CTRL-BRK or ANOM-SUS	Controls + A10	risk
Same PO > N open exceptions (illustrative: 5)	A06 + A15	P0-QLTY
Waiting-external > 2× SLA	A09 or A08 as applicable	silence
Taxonomy miss (no code fits)	AP Manager (table change)	process

Do not escalate: first-day GR-MISS still inside the GR wait policy. Do not escalate every PRC-VAR under the buyer's ordinary authority.

10. Output standard

10.1 triage_result

```

primary_reason_code
secondary_reason_codes[]
next_agent           # A05 | A06 | A07 | A08 | A09 | A10 | A16
human_owner_role
human_owner_named
sla_due
related_object_ids[]
retriage_of          # object version
priority             # from value band + due date + code

```

Done (Level 1): triage_decision recorded; A16 dispatches next_agent.

10.2 A04_aging_pack (daily)

Buckets: 0–2, 3–5, 6–10, 11+ operating days (illustrative buckets). By code, owner, company code, \$ open. Inventory must reconcile to ERP hold count $\pm$ explained deltas.

10.3 Weekly feed to A15

Closed exceptions: code, vendor, PO type, days open, closer, rework flag.

11. Control requirements

1. **Taxonomy lock.** New codes go through AP Manager + A16.
2. **One primary code.** Prevents vanity closure metrics.
3. **Work object is system of record.** Ticket mirrors cannot close it.
4. **SLA table versioned.** Courtesy extensions logged as policy overrides, not hidden.
5. **SOD.** Exception Lead is not payment releaser.
6. **Completeness.** Every A02/A03 fail must appear within the intake SLA. Missing = A16 incident.
7. **Sample.** 25 routings/week vs human second-code until promotion.

12. Audit evidence to retain

EVIDENCE	PULL FROM	RETENTION
Triage results + decisions	Work log	Local financial-record policy
Routing and SLA table versions	Change control	Same
Aging packs vs ERP hold recon	A14	Same
Escalation events	A16	Same
Satellite ticket IDs (if any)	Object	Same

13. KPIs

FAMILY	KPI	FORMULA	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER	PROMOTION
Activity	Triage coverage	Triaged / new exceptions	Work log	Daily	Exception Lead	→ 1.00

FAMILY	KPI	FORMULA	SOURCE	CADENCE	OWNER	PROMOTION
Operational	Re-route rate	Owner changed after accept / items	Work log	Weekly	Exception Lead	1 → 2
Operational	Aging p90	Days open	Aging pack	Daily	A16	
Operational	SLA hit rate	Closed or waiting_external before SLA / items	Work log	Weekly	Exception Lead	
Financial	\$ aged > 10 days	Sum	Aging pack	Daily	AP Manager	
Financial	Duplicate-chase \$	Related objects that chased twice	Link log	Monthly	Exception Lead	
Risk	Code invent attempts	Rejected unknown codes	A16	Weekly	Controls	
Risk	Closed-in-ticket-only	Mirrors closed, object open (target 0 after 48h)	Recon	Daily	Controls	
Risk	Override-for-error	Wrong primary code / decisions	Decision log	Weekly	Controls	Band
No “tickets closed” vanity metric without \$ and age.						

14. Performance history fields

Common fields, plus:

```
primary_code_distribution
reroute_count
sla_hit
sla_miss
aged_gt_10_days_amount
related_links
taxonomy_miss
erp_hold_recon_delta
```

15. Starting autonomy level

Level 1 — Recommend. First promotion: Level 2 (draft workflow assignment) after re-route rate and coverage gates. Auto-resolve is never in the envelope.

16. Failure handling

FAILURE	DETECT	DEGRADE	NOTIFY	RESUME
Taxonomy unpublished	Lookup	Hard stop	A16	Publish
Directory miss	No buyer	Owner = Exception Lead	Lead	Directory fix
Upstream evidence missing	Empty refs	Return upstream	A02/ A03	Re-open
Double dispatch	Two next_agents	A16 lock	A16	Single route
Ticket mirror outage	API	Continue on work object	Systems	Repair mirror later
Model invents code PRICE_ISSUE	Guardrail	Reject; force taxonomy	Controls	Retrain/rule

17. Cost monitoring

COST OBJECT	MEASURE	WHO ACTS
Classification API per item	Adapter	Systems
Human triage minutes	Time	Exception Lead
Mis-route minutes on receiving/procurement	Complaints confirmed	A05/A06 owners
Satellite ticket licence vs object-only	A14	AP Manager

18. Worked example — Northline Industrial Group

Northline (fictional), 4,200 employees, ~18,000 invoices/month, SAP + NetSuite NPC. Exception lead: Marcus Hale.

Object. Helion HF-88421 line 4 PRC-VAR \$40 / 3.3% outside NL-TOL-2026-04.

Level 1. A04 reads A03 evidence, sets primary PRC-VAR, secondary none, next_agent = A09, owner = PO buyer (Greta Holm's category buyer, not Marcus), SLA 3 operating

days per the value band < \$500 (illustrative). Links no open GR chase. Marcus accepts.

A16 dispatches A09. A04 does not email Helion and does not change the PO.

Noise variant. A processor wants a new code `HELION_PRICE`. A04 refuses. If Helion is a repeating price-defect vendor, A15 will say so from `PRC-VAR` volume — that is the point of a locked taxonomy.

Illegal. Closing the exception because a ServiceNow ticket auto-closed. Writing off \$40. Sending the supplier a debit note.

Control. Daily aging pack shows HF-88421 in 0–2 day bucket, \$14,260 still parked. ERP hold count for NL10 reconciles.

Charter conformance

- [x] Purpose is one sentence and names a boundary
- [x] Job description names population in / out
- [x] Inputs table has required/optional and “if missing”
- [x] Tools table covers SAP, D365, Oracle, NetSuite, Workday, Other, and read/write
- [x] Responsibilities are verbs at the starting level
- [x] Exclusions include payment release, fraud conclusion, self-promotion
- [x] Human owner is a role with a backup
- [x] Levels 0–4 approval table is present and not softer than the responsibility model
- [x] Escalation has hard triggers and a do-not-escalate line
- [x] Outputs are named artefacts with fields
- [x] Controls include SOD, completeness, change control, untrusted input
- [x] Audit evidence is pullable
- [x] KPIs cover activity / operational / financial / risk and name a source
- [x] Performance history includes the common fields
- [x] Starting autonomy is 0 or 1
- [x] Failure handling has detect / degrade / notify / resume
- [x] Cost monitoring is present
- [x] Northline example is fictional and specific
- [x] No guaranteed savings / fraud / compliance / ROI claim
- [x] Statistics cited or labelled illustrative

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